

GOVERNOR GENERAL + VICEROY OF INDIA

From Governors to Crown Rule

For SSC CGL, CHSL, UP Police Constable & other exams | Author: Parmar Clips

● Headings & Definitions ● Explanations ● Highlighter = Key Facts 🎯 Exam Tip ✖ Common Mistake
🧠 Memory Trick

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UNDERSTANDING KEY TERMS

British India had three main administrative units — the Three Presidencies: Bengal, Bombay, and Madras.

Bengal was the most important presidency, housing 40% of British India's population.

Governor of Bengal



The initial administrative head of Bengal. First Governor of Bengal: Robert Clive (served twice).

Governor General of Bengal

- Created by the Regulating Act of 1773 to control corruption within the East India Company.
- The Governor of Bengal was elevated to Governor General of Bengal.
- Governors of Bombay and Madras were made subordinate to the Governor General of Bengal.
- First Governor General of Bengal: Warren Hastings (also the last Governor of Bengal).

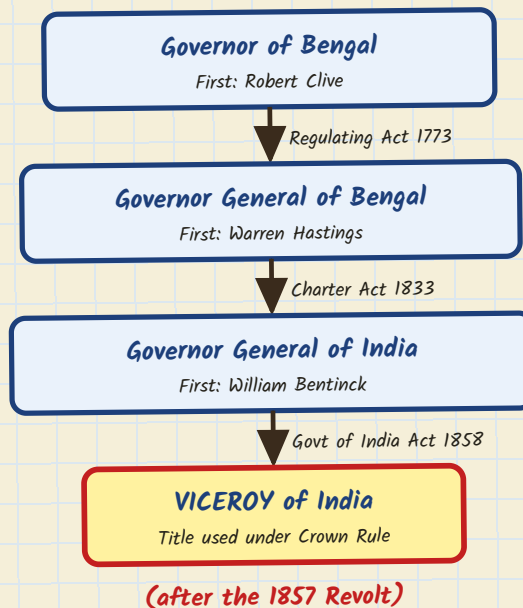
Governor General of India

- Created by the *Charter Act of 1833* (also known as the **St. Helena Act**).
- The Governor General of Bengal was elevated to Governor General of India.
- First Governor General of India: **William Bentinck** (also the last Governor General of Bengal).

Viceroy

- After the Revolt of 1857, the East India Company's rule ended, and **Crown Rule** was established by the *Government of India Act of 1858*.
- The title of Governor General of India was changed to **Viceroy**.

 Fig 1: Evolution of the Top Post



Quick Fact

Robert Clive was the first Governor of Bengal and served **twice** in that role.



Exam Tip

Match Act → Title created: **Regulating Act 1773** → **Governor General of Bengal**;
Charter Act 1833 → **Governor General of India**; **Govt of India Act 1858** → **Viceroy**.



Common Mistake

Don't confuse "Governor of Bengal" with "Governor General of Bengal" — Warren Hastings was both the last Governor of Bengal AND the first Governor General of Bengal!



Memory Trick

"1773 Regulate → 1833 Elevate → 1858 Crown-ate": Regulating Act regulated corruption, Charter Act elevated the post to all-India level, and the Govt of India Act crowned the post as Viceroy.



Why were these posts created? (tap to expand) ▼

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WARREN HASTINGS (1773-1785)

First Governor General of Bengal.

Key Acts

- Regulating Act of 1773.
- Pitt's India Act of 1784.



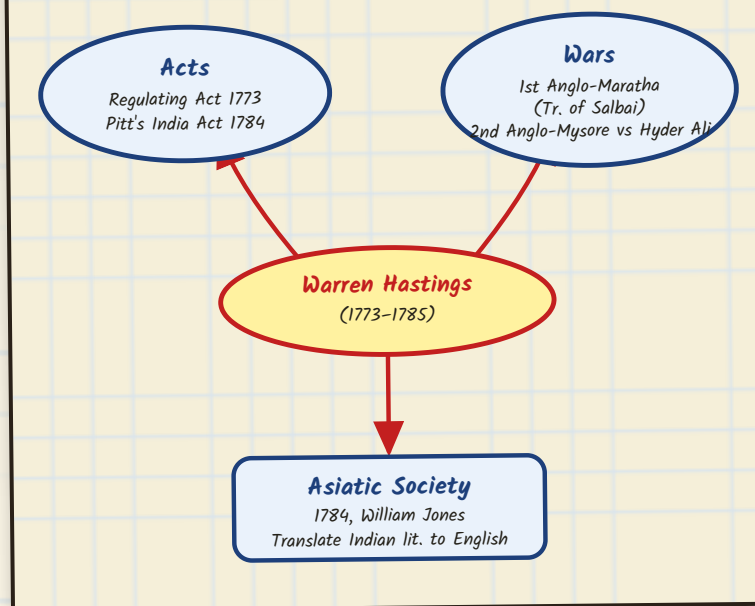
Wars

- First Anglo-Maratha War — ended with the Treaty of Salbai.
- Second Anglo-Mysore War — ended with the Treaty of Mangalore. Hyder Ali was the ruler of Mysore during this war.

Other

Establishment of the Asiatic Society of Bengal in 1784 by William Jones. Objective: translate Indian literature into English.

Fig 2: Warren Hastings – Mind Map



Note

The **Second Anglo-Mysore War** ended with the Treaty of Mangalore — Hyder Ali ruled Mysore at the time.

Warren Hastings' wars – treaty recap (tap to expand) ▼

LORD CORNWALLIS (1786-1793) Key Reforms

- Introduced the **Permanent Settlement** (also known as the **Zamindari System**) in **1793** in the Bengal region.
- Known as the **Father of Indian Civil Services** — introduced a merit-based civil services system.
- Introduced the **Cornwallis Code**, which brought judicial reforms and **separated revenue administration from civil jurisdiction**.

Wars

- **Third Anglo-Mysore War** — ended with the **Treaty of Seringapatam**.

Other

Died in India; his tomb is in Ghazipur.



Cornwallis = 3 C's: **Civil services** (merit-based), **Cornwallis Code** (judicial reform), and **Permanent Settlement** (Zamindari, Bengal, 1793).

✗ Common Mistake

Don't confuse Cornwallis's **Permanent Settlement** (Zamindari, Bengal, 1793) with the **Ryotwari** or **Mahalwari** systems introduced later by other Governors-General.

🧠 Memory Trick

Cornwallis died in India and is buried in **Ghazipur** — he stayed "permanently" in India, just like his Permanent Settlement was meant to last forever!

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JOHN SHORE (1793-1798)

Not considered important for exam purposes.

LORD WELLESLEY (1798-1805)

Key Policy – Subsidiary Alliance (1798)

- Objective: **prevent French (Napoleonic) influence** by making Indian rulers dependent on the British.
- Provisions: stationing a British Resident, disbanding native armies, maintaining British forces — in exchange for protection.
- First to adopt: **Nizam of Hyderabad (1798)**.
- Other adopters: **Mysore (1799), Awadh (1801)**.

Adopter of Subsidiary Alliance	Year
Nizam of Hyderabad	1798 (first)
Mysore	1799

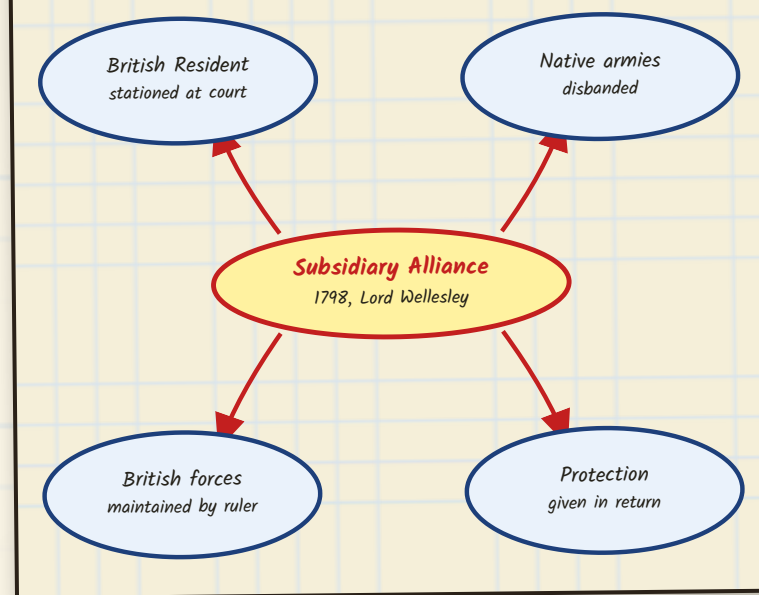
Wars

- Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799) — led to the death of Tipu Sultan.
- Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803–1805).

Treaties

- Treaty of Bassein (1802) between **Baji Rao II** and the British.

Fig 3: Subsidiary Alliance – Mind Map



👤 Treaty of Bassein, 1802 (tap to expand) ▼



📖 Quick Note

The **Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799)** ended Tipu Sultan's rule — the same year Mysore adopted the Subsidiary Alliance.

🎯 Exam Tip

Subsidiary Alliance adoption order by year: **Hyderabad (1798) → Mysore (1799) → Awadh (1801)**.

❌ Common Mistake

Don't confuse the **Subsidiary Alliance** (Wellesley, 1798 — dependency, not annexation) with the **Doctrine of Lapse** (Dalhousie, 1848 — annexation on no heir). Different Governors-General, different tools!



Memory Trick

Tipu Sultan died in the **Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799)** — the very same year Mysore accepted the Subsidiary Alliance. One war, two outcomes!

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LORD MINTO I (1807–1813) Treaties

- Treaty of Amritsar (1809) signed between **Maharaja Ranjit Singh** and the British.
- The **Sutlej River** was declared the boundary.

LORD HASTINGS (1813–1823) Wars

- Third Anglo-Maratha War (1817–1819).
- Anglo-Nepal War — ended with the **Treaty of Sugauli**.

Land Revenue Systems

- **Ryotwari System** — introduced in **1820** in Madras and other regions. Introduced by **Munro and Read**. Direct revenue collection from peasants (Ryots).
- **Mahalwari System** — introduced in **1822** in Punjab and NWFP regions. Introduced by **Holt Mackenzie and William Bentinck**. Revenue collected from groups of villages (Mahals).

System	Year	Region	Introduced By	Basis of Collection
Ryotwari	1820	Madras & other regions	Munro & Read	Individual peasants (Ryots)

Mahalwari

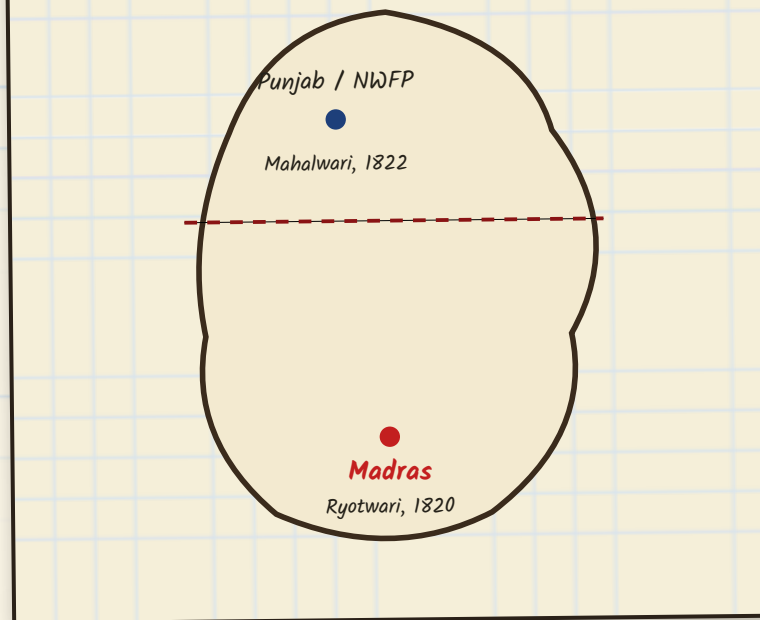
1822

Punjab & NWFP

Holt Mackenzie & William
Bentinck

Groups of villages
(Mahals)

 Fig 4: Ryotwari vs Mahalwari Regions



 Quick Note

Treaty of Amritsar (1809) fixed the **Sutlej River** as the boundary between British territory and Ranjit Singh's kingdom.

 Anglo-Nepal War & Treaty of Sugauli (tap to expand) ▼

 Exam Tip

Name tells you the system: **Ryotwari** = collection from **Ryots** (individual peasants); **Mahalwari** = collection from **Mahals** (village groups).

 Common Mistake

Don't mix up who introduced what: **Munro & Read** → **Ryotwari**; **Holt Mackenzie & William Bentinck** → **Mahalwari**.

 Memory Trick

Year order: **Ryotwari (1820)** before **Mahalwari (1822)** — just remember "20 comes before 22"!

WILLIAM BENTINCK (1828-1835)

First Governor General of India.

Social Reforms

- Abolition of **Sati** (with efforts from **Raja Ram Mohan Roy**).
- Suppression of the **Thuggee** system.

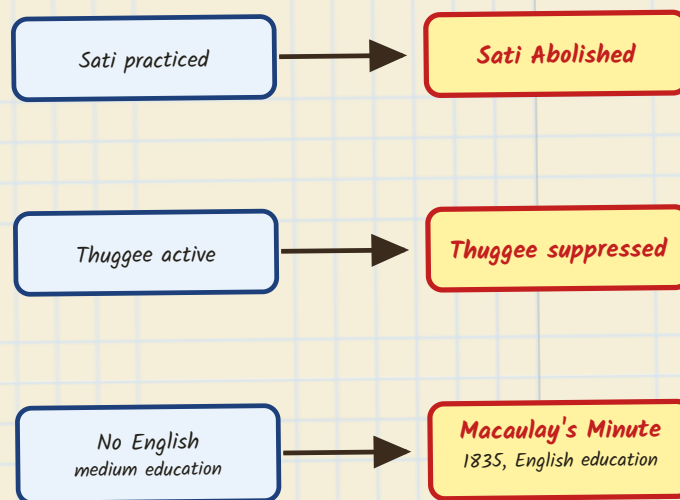
Administrative Reforms

- Abolished Provincial and Circuit Courts (introduced by Cornwallis).

Education

- **Macaulay's Minute (1835)** introduced, promoting English education — based on the **Downward Filtration Theory**.
- Sometimes called the **Father of English Education in India**.

Fig 5: Bentinck's Reforms – Before → After



Downward Filtration Theory

Educate a small English-speaking elite class, who would then "filter down" knowledge to the masses — the idea behind Macaulay's Minute, 1835.

CHARLES METCALFE (1835-1836)

Known as the **Liberator of Indian Press**. Repealed the **1823 Ordinance** that restricted press freedom.



LORD AUCKLAND (1836-1842) Wars

- First Anglo-Afghan War.

Other

Maharaja Ranjit Singh died during his tenure.

LORD HARDINGE I (1844-1848) Wars

- First Anglo-Sikh War.

Treaties

- Treaty of Lahore (after the First Anglo-Sikh War).



Exam Tip

Bentinck = 3 reforms: **Sati abolished** + **Thuggee suppressed** + **Macaulay's Minute** (English education) — earning him the title "Father of English Education in India"!



Common Mistake

Remember **Charles Metcalfe** only for one thing in this topic — the "**Liberator of Indian Press**" who repealed the 1823 Ordinance. Don't attach other reforms to him.



Memory Trick

Ranjit Singh died during **Auckland's** tenure — right around the **First Anglo-Afghan War**. Punjab's strongman gone, British attention moved to Afghanistan next!



Macaulay's Minute & Downward Filtration Theory (tap to expand) ▼

LORD DALHOUSIE (1848-1856)

Key Policy (Negative) – Doctrine of Lapse

Introduced in 1848. Policy: if an Indian ruler died **without a natural heir**, their kingdom would be **annexed** by the British.

State Annexed (in order)	Year
Satara	1848
Jaitpur and Sambalpur	1849
Udaipur	1852
Jhansi	1853
Nagpur	1854
Awadh	1856

Satara 1848



Jaitpur & Sambalpur 1849



Udaipur 1852



Jhansi 1853



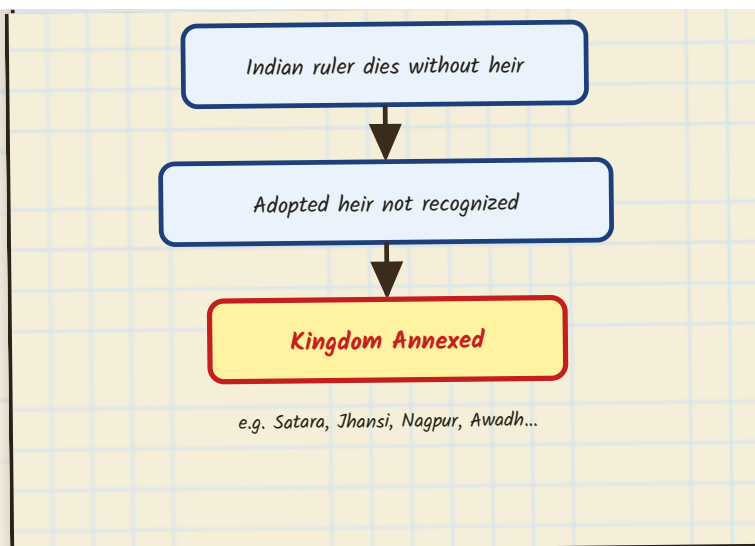
Nagpur 1854



Awadh 1856



Fig 6: Doctrine of Lapse – Flowchart



Key Reforms (Positive)

- Introduced telegraph lines.
- First train service started in 1853 (Bombay to Thane).
- Established the Public Works Department (PWD).
- Introduced postal reforms.
- Drafted the Widow Remarriage Act (passed during Canning's tenure).

Wars

- Second Anglo-Sikh War.



Exam Trap

Dalhousie only **drafted** the Widow Remarriage Act — it was actually **passed** during Lord Canning's tenure.



Common Mistake

Don't credit Dalhousie for **passing** the Widow Remarriage Act — he only **drafted** it; it was passed during **Lord Canning's** tenure!



Exam Tip

Doctrine of Lapse annexation order by year: 1848 Satara → 1849 Jaitpur & Sambalpur → 1852 Udaipur → 1853 Jhansi → 1854 Nagpur → 1856 Awadh.



Memory Trick

Dalhousie = both Positive + Negative: **Telegraph, Trains (1853), PWD, Post** (progress) vs **Doctrine of Lapse** (annexation) — India's most "productive but controversial" Governor-General!

SUMMARY

The British administration in India evolved through different phases, marked by changes in the title and powers of its chief representative. Initially, Governors managed individual presidencies. The *Regulating Act of 1773* centralized power by creating the Governor General of Bengal, making **Warren Hastings** the first to hold this expanded role. The *Charter Act of 1833* further consolidated authority, establishing the Governor General of India, with **William Bentinck** as the first. Finally, the *Government of India Act of 1858*, following the 1857 Revolt, replaced the Governor General with the Viceroy, signifying direct Crown rule.

- **1773** — Regulating Act — created Governor General of Bengal (first: Warren Hastings)
- **1833** — Charter Act — created Governor General of India (first: William Bentinck)
- **1858** — Government of India Act — replaced Governor General with Viceroy; Crown Rule begins

1773 → 1833 → 1858: Bengal → India → Viceroy

 Full Governance Evolution Recap (tap to expand) ▼



Keywords

Governor General · Viceroy · British India · Regulating Act · Doctrine of Lapse

★ Exam-Ready Summary

- **Three Presidencies:** Bengal, Bombay, Madras — Bengal had 40% of the population.
- **1773:** Regulating Act → Governor General of Bengal (first: Warren Hastings).
- **1833:** Charter Act (St. Helena Act) → Governor General of India (first: William Bentinck).

- **1858:** Government of India Act → Governor General became Viceroy; Crown Rule begins.
- Key policies to remember: **Permanent Settlement (1793)**, **Subsidiary Alliance (1798)**, **Ryotwari (1820)**, **Mahalwari (1822)**, **Doctrine of Lapse (1848)**.

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